

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
FOR THE DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA

JOSEPH KIRCHNER,
Plaintiff,
v.
MIKE JOHNSON et al.,
Defendants.

Case No. 1:25-cv-02735-ACR

**DECLARATION OF CHRISTOPHER
WHITTICK IN SUPPORT OF PLAINTIFF'S
OPPOSITIONS TO DEFENDANTS' MOTIONS
TO DISMISS (ECF NOS. 69 AND 70)**

(28 U.S.C. § 1746(1))

I, Christopher Henry Charles Whittick, declare as follows:

1. I am over the age of eighteen and reside in Lewes, East Sussex, England. I make this declaration from personal knowledge of the matters stated in it.
2. I read Jurisprudence at the University of Oxford and hold the degree of Master of Arts. I am a Deputy Lieutenant of the county of East Sussex, a Fellow of the Society of Antiquaries of London, and a Fellow of the Royal Historical Society. Between 1975 and 2019 I served in English county archives, latterly as County Archivist of East Sussex. I am now a self-employed archivist, translator, editor and teacher. My professional work has centred on English records of the medieval and early modern periods, including the palaeography of sixteenth- and seventeenth-century legal hands. I have taught post-medieval palaeography to the staff of The National Archives of the United Kingdom, to archive students at University College London and on the Keele University palaeography programme, and I am an active editor of published editions of both medieval and early-modern legal records.
3. On 14 July 2026 I was retained by the plaintiff, Joseph Kirchner, on agreed professional terms, to produce a verification transcription of the surviving documents in The National Archives (UK) file STAC 8/203/38 (Court of Star Chamber, 1607): the interrogatories, the

depositions, and the answer in an action brought in 1607 by Rees Jevan ap Lloyd against John Lewis, a former sheriff of the county of Anglesey. It is the surviving file of the Star Chamber proceedings which is included in the printed reports of Sir Edward Coke as *Floyd v. Barker*. The case also appears in Coke's manuscript notebooks, published in the edition of Sir John Baker for the Selden Society (volume 142 of 2024), which explains the circumstances of the removal of the bill of complaint from the file.

4. Between 13 and 31 July 2026 I prepared preliminary transcripts of all three documents from photographic images of them.

5. On 1 August 2026 I examined the original documents at The National Archives, Kew. I photographed them, in part under ultraviolet light to recover readings in faded or damaged areas, and made a first collation of my preliminary transcripts against the originals.

6. Between 2 and 4 August 2026 I prepared written responses, some illustrated by my photographs of the originals, to two lists of specific readings submitted to me by Mr. Kirchner, and collated the transcripts accordingly.

7. On 4 August 2026 I delivered to Mr. Kirchner transcripts of the interrogatories, the depositions, and the answer. Those transcripts are my own work. Where a reading remains uncertain, the transcripts preserve the uncertainty by editorial convention rather than resolving it by conjecture.

8. To the best of my professional judgment, the transcripts I have supplied accurately represent the text of the original documents, subject to the queries and uncertainties marked in them.

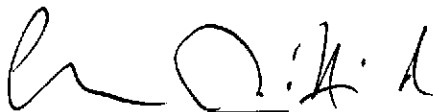
9. I have authorized Mr. Kirchner to quote, reproduce, and file the transcripts I have supplied in this litigation and any appeal. The text of record and its publication remain mine, and I have asked to be identified as the author of any transcripts I have supplied.

10. I have been compensated for my professional services at my standard hourly rates. My compensation does not depend on the content of my findings, the readings I report, or the outcome of any litigation.

11. The surviving file of STAC 8/203/38 is the primary manuscript record of proceedings in the Court of Star Chamber in 1607; so far as I am aware, no transcription of the file has previously been made or published. In my professional judgment the file is of genuine significance for the study of English legal records and English legal history, and its transcription, verification against the originals, and preparation for publication constitute a serious scholarly undertaking. I have only a basic understanding of the significance of the case to American jurisprudence, and am indifferent to the outcome of the litigation in which my work is to be produced.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States of America that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed on August 11, 2026, at Lewes, England.



Christopher Whittick

